

Contact

Dubai, United Arab Emirates
+971503734513 (Mobile)
vakoowen@mail.ru

www.linkedin.com/in/vardges-petrosyan-9b6340159 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Automation
Artificial Intelligence (AI)
Business Correspondence

Languages

Russian (Native or Bilingual)
English (Full Professional)

Certifications

Design Prompts for Everyday Work Tasks
Use AI as a Creative or Expert Partner
Strategic Negotiation
AI Infrastructure and Operations Fundamentals
Negotiation Foundations

Vardges Petrosyan

Bar Manager at BFF Sports Bar/ Founder of 'The Cocktail Tree'
Dubai, United Arab Emirates

Summary

Hey there!

I'm the guy who's mixed more cocktails than Bond has had martinis. hehe!

When looking back at my journey, it feels that my career has been a mosaic of vibrant experiences somewhat like mixing the perfect cocktail - a blend of experience, each adding its unique flavor to my professional life.

Moving onto the base of my cocktail - my early days in Armenia. Here I learned how a challenge could turn into a great opportunity, and with it, overcoming the personal hurdles I discovered that a good bartender doesn't just mix the drinks; he mixes smiles and stories.

In Moscow, my Head Bartender stint pebbled like a twist of lemon in a drink. Here I learned that understanding over 500 beverage items wasn't simply memorizing recipes; rather, it was about embracing the rich tapestry of global beverage culture.

The sunny shores of the UAE at Miramar taught me adaptability – as in, the skill to switch from beachside ease to disco fever seamlessly. Managing different settings and diverse crowds further polished my versatility and showed me the true meaning of 'customer delight.'

Abu Dhabi brought me as close to my dream career worldwide injection as adding a shot of espresso. At the Blu Sky, I learned that leadership in hospitality is not about directing a team; it's more of inspiring them to shake up their best.

The Bus Tour? Now that was the garnish to my professional journey! Hopping across 33 countries and over 65 cities, it was not all recipes I collected but experiences that kept adding depth to this cocktail.

Fast forward to my role at Sheraton Al Khalidiya with Sabah Group. Managing over 20 outlets felt like juggling a cocktail glass – it was dazzling, and I was learning. That was like an almighty crash course in large-scale management of hospitality, where I learned how synergy could be created, and strategy adapted, ruling the F&B universe.

My adventure at BFF Sports Bar in Dubai is where I combine all these elements. Here, I don't manage plain; I invent, and create an area that copies my path, more cultures, and always poised to awe.

And so, through it all, founding 'The Cocktail Tree' was my way of sharing this rich concoction of experiences. It isn't just another company. It's the channel to pour out what I have learned – about mixology, about people, and life.

So, cheers to a journey that has been nothing short of intoxicating. Each experience itself was an adventure teaching me resilience, ingenuity, and the essence of hospitality. The journey is continued, more lessons are incoming, more giggles, and of course, more cocktails!

Experience

Vkusno

Director of Marketing And Business Development

March 2024 - Present (2 years 4 months)

Dubai, United Arab Emirates

As the Business Development and Marketing Manager at Vkusno, I focus on driving growth and promoting our authentic Russian cuisine to a broad audience. My role combines strategic business development with innovative marketing and tech solutions to build Vkusno's presence in UAE.

Key Responsibilities:

Business Development :

Partner with top delivery platforms (Talabat, Careem, Deliveroo, Noon Food) to streamline delivery operations and ensure a seamless customer experience.

Identify and pursue new markets and customer segments to expand our footprint across Dubai.

Marketing Strategy :

Develop and execute digital and offline marketing campaigns to boost brand awareness and customer engagement.

Utilize SEO, social media, and content strategies to promote Vkusno and drive traffic to our platforms.

Collaborate with influencers and local food bloggers to increase brand visibility through paid and organic promotions.

Brand Identity & Projects #:

Lead the development and refinement of Vkusno's brand identity to ensure it resonates with our target audience.

Oversee the development of our website and work on the creation of our mobile app to enhance the customer experience and accessibility.

Manage various projects aimed at improving our digital presence and creating a cohesive, user-friendly brand experience.

Implement customer feedback systems to adapt our offerings and ensure high levels of customer satisfaction.

Create loyalty programs and seasonal campaigns to foster customer retention and repeat business.

Coordinate with operations and logistics to ensure that marketing efforts align with delivery capacity and efficiency.

Financial Oversight :

Manage the marketing budget, ensuring that all campaigns are cost-effective and aligned with overall business objectives.

Ultimately, my role is about more than marketing – it's about building a brand that represents the rich heritage of Russian cuisine while embracing Dubai's dynamic food scene .

The Cocktail Tree

Founder

January 2022 - Present (4 years 6 months)

Dubai, United Arab Emirates

"As the Founder and Visionary at 'The Cocktail Tree', I've embarked on a journey to revolutionize the world of beverages and make them more accessible, innovative, and engaging for everyone.

From the roots of a passion for mixology, I nurtured the concept of 'The Cocktail Tree,' a brand that simplifies the complexities of the beverage industry. My vision is to create a single, comprehensive solution to address the multifaceted challenges faced by bars, restaurants, and beverage enthusiasts.

My role involves driving the company's mission, guiding the team, and overseeing the development of products and services. I'm dedicated to providing cost-effective alternatives and out-of-the-box thinking to deliver unique solutions for the industry.

'The Cocktail Tree' is not just a company; it's a manifestation of my love for all things related to beverages. It's an extension of my passion for mixology, training, and consulting.

Based in Dubai, UAE, we bring a global perspective to the beverage industry while acknowledging the cultural nuances. As we transition from tradition to innovation, my goal is to simplify the complex beverage landscape for aspiring bartenders, bar supervisors, restaurant owners, and managers.

The Cocktail Tree logo, with its six roots representing iconic cocktail families, symbolizes our commitment to excellence in the world of beverages. The two-toned tree signifies our unique approach, where simplicity meets creativity.

Join me in this exciting journey to unlock the potential of your establishment with 'The Cocktail Tree.' Together, we'll craft memorable moments, one cocktail at a time."

BFF Sports Bar

Bar Manager

December 2018 - September 2024 (5 years 10 months)

Dubai, United Arab Emirates

In December 2018, I embarked on a new challenge as the Bar Manager at BFF Sports Bar in Dubai, a pivotal moment in my evolving hospitality career. This role was an amalgamation of my accumulated experiences, set in the vibrant and fast-paced world of a leading sports bar.

At BFF Sports Bar, my role transcended typical management duties. I was at the forefront of orchestrating an engaging atmosphere, ensuring each guest's visit was memorable. My responsibilities were diverse, encompassing the full spectrum of bar management and customer engagement .

Key responsibilities in this role included:

Overseeing all aspects of bar operations, from service excellence to administrative management.

Continuously innovating the beverage menu, introducing exciting and unique drinks.

Mentoring and training a dynamic team, enhancing their skills for top-notch service.

Streamlining operational processes for maximum efficiency and customer satisfaction.

Providing personalized guest experiences, fostering loyalty and repeat business.

Staying ahead of industry trends to keep BFF Sports Bar at the forefront of Dubai's hospitality scene.

Cultivating a diverse and inclusive environment, both for staff and guests.

Analyzing performance metrics and strategizing for continual business growth and improvement.

Collaborating with the culinary team to create complementary food and beverage pairings.

Organizing and managing special events and promotions, enhancing the bar's reputation and customer base.

Implementing quality control measures to maintain the highest standards of service and product.

My tenure at BFF Sports Bar has been a testament to my growth and adaptability as a hospitality professional. It has allowed me to refine my management skills, innovate within the industry, and make a significant impact in the dynamic world of bar management in Dubai.

Subah Group

Group Bar Manager

March 2018 - August 2018 (6 months)

Abu Dhabi

In March 2018, I embarked on a significant new chapter in my hospitality career with Sabah Group Hotel Management at the Sheraton Al Khalidiya

Hotel, Abu Dhabi, stepping into the role of Outlet Manager and Acting Bar Manager at The 3rd Avenue Pub. This position was not just a job, but a foray into the complex world of large-scale hospitality management, overseeing the operations of more than 20 different food and beverage outlets across Abu Dhabi.

At the heart of my responsibilities was The 3rd Avenue Pub, where I applied my leadership skills to manage the venue effectively. Beyond the day-to-day operations of this bustling pub, my role expanded across the group's network of outlets. I played a crucial role in strategizing operations, enhancing customer service strategies, and driving business growth .

Key responsibilities in this expansive role included:

Managing the operations of multiple food and beverage outlets across Abu Dhabi.

Leading large teams, fostering a collaborative and skill-enhancing environment.

Strategizing operational plans for multiple venues, contributing to overall business growth and efficiency.

Conducting staff training programs, elevating service standards across the group.

Building and strengthening relationships with a diverse range of guests and staff.

Innovating in service and operational procedures, adapting to the dynamic market and customer needs.

This tenure at Sheraton Al Khalidiya Hotel and The 3rd Avenue Pub was more than a career move; it was a transformative journey that deepened my understanding of managing extensive hospitality operations. It honed my skills in large group management, preparing me for future endeavors in the ever-evolving world of hospitality.

Southern Sun

Head Bartender

January 2015 - October 2016 (1 year 10 months)

Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates

In January 2015, I embraced a new challenge in the vibrant city of Abu Dhabi, joining the Southern Sun Hotel's Blu Sky Lounge and Grill. My journey here began as a Bartender, where I quickly adapted to the pulsating energy of this

cosmopolitan city. My role at Blu Sky was a blend of mixology artistry and exceptional customer service, set against the backdrop of an upbeat and trendy sports bar environment.

At Blu Sky, my expertise in crafting an extensive variety of drinks was paired with a deep understanding of the guests' diverse tastes and preferences. The bar's dynamic atmosphere provided the perfect platform for me to showcase my skills, from creating classic cocktails to experimenting with innovative concoctions. My ability to connect with guests from all over the world further enhanced their experience, making each visit memorable.

My dedication and passion for the hospitality industry were recognized, leading to my promotion to Head Bartender. In this elevated role, I took on greater responsibilities, managing the bar operations, mentoring the team, and ensuring that each guest received the highest level of service. My tenure at Blu Sky Lounge and Grill, until October 2016, was not only about serving drinks but also about leading a team to create a vibrant and welcoming atmosphere for every guest.

Key responsibilities in this role included:

Navigating the diverse cultural landscape of Abu Dhabi.

Mastering a wide array of mixology techniques to cater to sophisticated tastes.

Managing the bar's operations, ensuring smooth service even during peak hours.

Leading and mentoring a team of bartenders, fostering a collaborative and skillful bar environment.

Innovating the beverage menu, constantly introducing new and exciting drinks to delight our guests.

My experience at Blu Sky Lounge was a significant milestone in my career, solidifying my position as a skilled and versatile hospitality professional.

Miramar Al Aqah Beach Resort

Bartender/ Acting Head Bartender

September 2013 - December 2014 (1 year 4 months)

Fujairah, United Arab Emirates

In 2013, I continued my journey, moving to the Miramar Al Aqa Beach Resort in Fujairah. Here, at the Bahari and Bliss, I embarked on an incredibly diverse role, initially as a Bartender before being promoted to Acting Head Bartender.

Nestled on the serene beaches of the UAE, this experience was a blend of exotic cultures and beachside hospitality.

My days at the Bahari Bar & Grill were bustling, catering to a predominantly tourist clientele with an extensive range of cocktails and beverages. My skills were not just confined behind the bar; I was an ambassador of the resort, engaging with guests from around the world, enhancing their vacation experience with every drink. As the sun set, my role shifted to the Bliss Disco, where the night came alive with music and dance, and my mixology skills were showcased under the vibrant lights of the disco.

During my tenure, until December 2014, I honed my ability to adapt to diverse customer needs, manage high-volume service, and maintain the highest standards in a dynamic beachside setting. This period at Miramar Al Aqa Beach Resort was not just about serving drinks; it was about creating an oasis of enjoyment for every guest, making their stay memorable and lively.

Some of my responsibilities in this role included:

Embracing the challenge of a dual role, transitioning from the relaxed daytime beach bar to the energetic night-time disco.

Crafting a wide variety of drinks, catering to international tastes and preferences.

Engaging with a diverse tourist clientele, providing exceptional service that catered to their unique needs.

Continuously learning and adapting to new mixology techniques and beverage trends, enhancing the guest experience.

Managing high-volume service with efficiency, ensuring every guest received attentive service.

This journey at Miramar Al Aqa Beach Resort was a pivotal point in my career, broadening my horizons and reinforcing my passion for the dynamic world of hospitality.

Hotel Metropol Moscow

Head Bartender

January 2013 - August 2013 (8 months)

Moscow, Russian Federation

In January 2013, I embarked on a new chapter in my bartending career, taking on the role of Head Bartender at the renowned Metropol Hotel's Shalyapin

Bar in Moscow, Russia. This step marked a significant elevation from my beginnings in Yerevan, thrusting me into the dynamic and diverse world of Moscow's elite hospitality scene.

I embraced the challenge of leading the bar team with gusto, fostering an environment where creativity and quality were paramount. My role entailed crafting innovative cocktail menus that tantalized the palate, managing a sophisticated inventory of over 500 different beverages, and upholding an unparalleled standard of customer service. This period was a whirlwind of learning and growth, as I navigated through the cultural mosaic of Moscow, fine-tuning my leadership skills and deepening my understanding of the intricacies of team dynamics in a bustling, high-end bar.

My time at the Shalyapin Bar in Metropol Hotel was not just a job; it was an adventure in adaptability and ambition, laying the groundwork for further endeavors in the ever-evolving world of hospitality. Here, I solidified my reputation as a versatile and innovative bartender, ready to take on the next challenge. This experience was instrumental in shaping my approach to hospitality, as I took on responsibilities that were both challenging and rewarding:

Leadership and Team Management: Guided and managed a diverse bar team.

Menu Development and Innovation: Spearheaded the creation of cocktail menus.

Inventory and Stock Control: Oversaw extensive inventory management.

Quality Assurance: Ensured top-notch quality and presentation.

Cultural Adaptability and Client Relations: Excelled in adapting to diverse cultural settings.

Each of these roles not only differentiated my experience from my initial foray into bartending but also equipped me with a unique skill set that I continue to leverage in my current position.

Congress Hotel

Bartender

March 2011 - January 2013 (1 year 11 months)

Yerevan, Armenia

In March 2011, I stepped into the vibrant world of bartending at the Congress Hotel Venice Outlet Bar in Yerevan, Armenia. Starting as a Bar Back, I quickly immersed myself in the art of hospitality, where every glass mixed and every

smile shared became a part of my journey. My dedication for the craft didn't go unnoticed, leading to my well-earned promotion to Bartender . During my time at the Venice Bar, until January 2013, I didn't just mix drinks; I crafted experiences . The bar became my stage , and every interaction with guests was an opportunity to create memorable moments .

Building on the foundation laid at the Congress Hotel Venice Outlet Bar, my role evolved beyond just mixing drinks. I prided myself on multitasking with grace, from managing inventory to upholding the bar's cleanliness . My personal touch in understanding both regular and new customers' preferences ♥# was a testament to my dedication. This role was a significant chapter in my career, where I sharpened my mixology skills, enhanced my customer engagement techniques, and learned the importance of team collaboration . Mentorship became a part of my repertoire, as I guided new staff with my accumulated wisdom . Keeping up with the latest trends, I consistently brought creativity and innovation to our drink offerings . This crucial period was not just about serving drinks; it was about excelling in the multifaceted world of hospitality and setting the stage for future growth.

This experience naturally led to excellence in:

Customer Service: Excelled in delivering personalized, attentive guest service .

Inventory Management: Managed stock efficiently, ensuring optimal inventory levels .

Cleanliness and Hygiene: Maintained high standards of bar cleanliness and hygiene .

Team Collaboration: Fostered smooth operations through effective team collaboration .

Beverage Knowledge and Innovation: Innovated with trendy and diverse beverage menu offerings .

Education

Zabeel International University

Certificate, Hotel & Hospitality Management · (2017 - 2017)

Lepsius High School No. 88

High School Diploma · (1998 - 2009)